Rapid Research

Snapshot Report: Onboarding

Why new users of Tallybird stall before connecting their first account, and what to fix first.

5	30 min	1	5 days
participants	remote interviews	focus area	kickoff to report

SAMPLE REPORT. Tallybird is a fictional budgeting app, and all findings, participants and quotes are illustrative.

Sample · Fictional product

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Users want the payoff before the setup.

Four of five participants abandoned or nearly abandoned onboarding at the bank-connection step. They didn't yet understand what Tallybird would show them, and asking for bank access that early felt like a risk with no clear reward. The fastest win is to show value **before** asking for a connection.

TOP 3 THINGS TO FIX

1. **Show a preview budget before asking for bank access.** Let people see what they'll get using sample data.
2. **Explain the security in plain words at the moment of the ask.** One line about read-only access beats a separate page they won't open.
3. **Make "skip for now" a real path.** Users who skipped got lost because the app didn't tell them what to do next.

AT A GLANCE

4/5
hesitated at bank connection

3/5
skipped setup, then got lost

2/5
unsure if their data was private

Sample · Fictional product

FINDINGS, RANKED BY IMPACT

What we heard

1. People didn't know what the app would do for them

HIGH SEVERITY

4 of 5 participants

The welcome screens describe features ("smart categories," "insights") but never show an actual budget. Participants couldn't picture the result, so the setup effort felt unjustified.

> *"I thought I had to connect everything before it would work, so I just closed it."*

Recommendation: Replace the feature carousel with a one-screen preview built from sample data, labeled "Here's what your month could look like."

2. Skipping setup led to a dead end

HIGH SEVERITY

3 of 5 participants

Participants who tapped "Skip" landed on an empty dashboard with no next step. Two went looking in Settings; one quit.

> *"Okay, now what? There's nothing here."*

Recommendation: Give the empty dashboard a single clear task, such as "Add your first expense manually," plus a gentle reminder to connect later.

3. Privacy worries surfaced at the worst moment

MEDIUM SEVERITY

2 of 5 participants

The bank-connection screen links to a security page, but nobody opened it. Concerns stayed unresolved and slowed the decision.

> *"Can they move money? I'd want to know that before I log in."*

Recommendation: Put one plain sentence on the connection screen itself: "Read-only. Tallybird can never move your money."

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WHAT TO DO NEXT

Fix-first plan

QUICK WINS · DAYS

- Add the read-only line to the connection screen
- Rename "Skip" to "Explore first"
- Add one next step to the empty dashboard

BIGGER BETS · WEEKS

- Sample-data preview budget before bank connection
- Manual-entry path that later upgrades to a connected account

HOW THIS STUDY WAS RUN

Method	Five 30-minute remote, audio-only interviews with a think-aloud walkthrough of onboarding
Participants	Adults who had tried at least one budgeting app in the past year; mix of ages and income levels; none were existing customers
Focus area	First-time onboarding, from download to first budget
Analysis	Each issue rated by how many participants hit it (frequency) and how badly it blocked them (severity)
Follow-up	One round of questions by email after delivery